SCIENCE DEPARTMENT • SCIENCE LITERACY & LESSON INTERNALIZATION

PLC AGENDA

Experience the Writing Benchmark as a Student

Science Literacy Learning Cycle — Complete the attached Biology HS-LS2-1 benchmark, analyze the task and visuals, use CUBS, color-code CER, and anticipate student thinking.

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026 | **41 MINUTES** | **GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE • BRING FORMS & EVIDENCE**

TODAY'S OUTCOME Leave with a completed shared benchmark, task/text/visual analysis, color-coded CER response, likely student responses and mistakes, and Lesson Internalization reflections to carry into Tuesday's lesson planning.

WHY THIS PLC MATTERS Teachers can plan more effectively when they first experience the benchmark as learners. Completing the task makes the content, reading, data/visual analysis, writing, language, and reasoning demands visible before students encounter them.

PROTOCOL CONNECTION
Every Day Questions 1, 3, and 4; Team Deep Dive Steps 2–4: clarify the learning goal and mastery bar, anticipate responses and misconceptions, and plan the student experience, access, and facilitation needs.

WHAT TO BRING
The attached Biology Benchmark #1 (digital or printed); Lesson Internalization Tool; three or four highlighter colors; and an upcoming course-specific article, data display, model, investigation prompt, or constructed-response task for transfer.

FOCUS TO PROTECT
The Biology benchmark is the shared model. Teachers complete it as students, then use CUBS to analyze the population graph, food web, and prompt before color-coding the Claim, Evidence, and Reasoning in their response.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

TIME (MIN)	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO	PRODUCT / CHECK
0:00–3:00	**Frame the shared learner experience**	Set the benchmark as a shared model for task analysis—not a measure or ranking of teachers, students, courses, or sections.	**Purpose**
3:00–17:00	**Complete the benchmark as a student**	Independently complete Biology Benchmark #1, including the fruit-fly graph, food-web questions, and Question 5 CER response.	**Student experience**
17:00–24:00	**Analyze task, texts, and visuals with CUBS**	Circle the main idea/question, underline supporting graph and food-web details, box high-leverage vocabulary, and summarize the science idea or question.	**Source analysis**
24:00–31:00	**Color-code CER + anticipate responses**	Identify claim, evidence, reasoning, and links in the response; share likely productive, partial, mistaken, or inaccessible student responses.	**Visible thinking**
31:00–39:00	**Lesson Internalization reflection**	Use Questions 1, 3, and 4 plus Steps 2–4 to record the mastery bar, anticipated response, access/facilitation implications, and one feedback/revision need.	**Instructional implications**
39:00–41:00	**Close + carry forward**	Bring the completed benchmark/task analysis, one anticipated student need, and one instructional question to Tuesday.	**Tuesday bridge**

PROTECTED INDIVIDUAL WORK WITH COLLEAGUE SUPPORT

WORK WITH COLLEAGUES

WHAT TO DO Complete the benchmark and reflection independently first. Then use colleagues to compare task demands and identify one high-leverage instructional implication while keeping the focus on student learning—not evaluation.

1. **Experience the task:** Complete the benchmark as a student before discussing instruction.
2. **Analyze source demands:** Use CUBS on the graph, food web, and writing prompt.
3. **Make CER visible:** Color-code the claim, evidence, and reasoning in the response.
4. **Anticipate student thinking:** Distinguish likely science, source-analysis, and writing/reasoning needs.
5. **Internalize for instruction:** Record what students need to learn, do, and experience before the benchmark.

USE THIS REFERENCE DURING GROUP WORK

WORK AS A STUDENT FIRST
Complete the task independently before analyzing it as an educator. The learner experience reveals the demand teachers will need to plan for.

USE CUBS + CER AS VISIBILITY ROUTINES
CUBS helps students analyze the source. Color-coded CER helps them notice whether the response contains a claim, relevant evidence, and scientific reasoning.

ANTICIPATE—DO NOT LABEL
Name likely student questions, partial responses, and mistakes as instructional information. Keep expectations high and plan access without lowering the demand.

COLLABORATION IN PRACTICE Protect time for thoughtful individual work; use respectful, student-centered feedback to make the next decision clearer.

TEACHER RUBRIC CONNECTION **Standard I: I-A-4 Well-Structured Lessons • Standard II: II-A-2 Student Engagement • Standard II: II-D-2 High Expectations • Standard IV: IV-C-1 Professional Collaboration**

